

I SWEAR OFFICER, THERE'S NO BLOOD IN MY ALCOHOL STREAM!

A collection of interesting studies

which exonerate booze in favour of high testosterone levels for driving accidents. Hick!
<http://bit.ly/digit6211>

ARM NOT AFRAID OF INTEL

The latest battle in the mobile space is going to be one based on architectures. While intel talked of x86 phones, ARM mobile strategist James Bruce claims that Intel has miles to go in the mobile space. Know more:w
<http://bit.ly/digit6212>

GADGET GYAN YOU OUGHT TO KNOW

Technology knowledge is a funny thing. Some just pick up and discover things along the way while some find it a little difficult. In this article, David Pogue from the New York Times tells us about some of the most basic things in tech that'll make you go, "I didn't know that!".
<http://nyti.ms/digit6213>

GRAPHENE 101

You'll find Graphene being mentioned as a wonder material several times in this issue, especially in the future tech section. If you're still clueless about what exactly it is and what all the fuss is about, be sure to check out this wonderful explanatory article from physorg:
<http://bit.ly/digit6214>

Consider an SSD as a Secondary Drive

- By Sal Cangeloso

Most high performance rig-builders use an SSD for installing the OS. Here's a twist to that concept.



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For some time now technology enthusiasts have understood the value of solid-state drives. Their excellent speed has largely outweighed their limited capacity and high per-gigabyte pricing, making them a easy choice for many. That is to say that SSDs have been an easy choice for use as a primary drive—where your operating system and most of your programs live. This, after all, is how you can get the most impact out of one of these newfangled storage devices.

as space will be cramped and you might be missing important features, like TRIM support. You might want to consider using your SSD as a secondary drive.

The key here is understanding that the benefits will not be as big as moving your primary hard drive to an SSD... but that's both a pain and an expensive proposition. Adding in a secondary drive is a 10 minute job and reasonably sized (say, 32GB) SSDs start at under \$100. If you are into building computers, you might even have one lying around. Most early consumer SSDs didn't perform all that well and so this is an ideal use for them.

If your OS won't be on the drive, then what are some good uses for that SSD?

- Adobe Lightroom catalog
- Storage of virtual machines
- Holding place to dump images and videos from a DSLR or other imaging device
- For installation of applications you'd like to load quickly
- Windows page file
- Linux /swap

You'll have to find which ideas work best for you, and individual needs may vary greatly based on the applications you use and how they work with your computers. The options above work great for me—an SSD speeds up the opening and closing of my virtual machines and Lightroom catalog/image previews. I don't have a lot of space on the SSD but it works well when called upon. (Note that those last two choices above could impact the life of the drive, but if you have it and it's not of much value to you, why not take full advantage of it?)

Are these applications, let's call them intermediate operations, alone worth the purchase of an SSD? Perhaps not, but with today's solid-state drives outshining older models it's clear that using a non-primary drive SSD can be a great way to shave seconds off certain operations.

Whether you want to quickly open huge PSD files or open up a virtual machine in the blink of an eye, a secondary SSD is a quick fix that can make your computer feel a lot faster for very targeted operations. It'll add some complexity to your backup scheme and you'll have to keep an eye on the available storage, but it's an upgrade worth considering and a step towards much faster storage.



The problem with this is that you'll want to get a high quality drive (and new one at that), but how do you reap the benefits of an SSD when using a smaller or older model? Your main drive won't be the best choice

Basically any instance in which you could benefit from quick storage will work, but some of the best I've found include:

Adobe Photoshop scratch disk (this shouldn't be your boot drive anyway)